



Cohort analysis lets you group your audience into statistical groups before analysis

total metric value for all cohorts for each column. For example, if the metric is Pageviews and the columns are daily data, then the first row shows the total pageviews for the day. The other rows show the values for the individual cohorts. The cells for time increments 0-12 hold the relevant metric values. For example, if you are using the Pageviews metric, then each cell contains the number of pageviews per cohort per time increment. Analytics uses a colour scheme spread over 5 colours to indicate of relative metric values: the darkest color is highest values and the lightest color is the lowest values.

The usage of this report is dependant upon the type of website or business you are running. Since the basic segmentation is done by date, select the appropriate date range for your business. If you are selling something online, use a shorter date period if your products are fast moving and cheap, and a longer date range if they are expensive. If you are running a blog that basically functions on attracting daily traffic, a daily cohort report would be ideal for you. If you want to check for an app, specifically in-app purchases, again a daily cohort report would be recommended. Select your metrics based also on your business type. If you have an e-commerce site, you might want to look at Revenue per User, Transactions per User and total Revenue.

Once you have setup the ideal report, save it as a shortcut. This saved report will appear in the list of reports under Cohort.

Overall, cohort analysis is useful to see how the user base and engagement has changed over a period of time since you acquired them. Do they keep coming back, are they engaging with your site, do they immediately taper off etc. You can also use this report to check the engagement metrics due to an ad. Say you run a Facebook ad in the first week of every month. Over the month, you see good acquisition data from the active report. But